

Curriculum Vitae

Clara Thomas
Stockton, California
c_thomas25@u.pacific.edu

EDUCATION

University of the Pacific

M.S. Student, Biology
January 2025 — present

Cornell University, College of Arts & Sciences

B.A., Environmental Biology and Applied Ecology
2018 — 2022

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

California State University, Los Angeles

Research Assistant, Wood Lab of Avian and Urban Ecology
May — December 2024

Urban food web dynamics. Conducted point-count bird surveys evaluating how the planting of 200 oak trees on campus contributed to urban biodiversity. Examined the capacity of native and non-native oaks to support urban food webs, including insects and birds.

U.S. Geological Survey, Southwest Biological Science Center

Biological Science Technician — Moab, Utah
February — December 2023

Terrestrial dryland ecology. Conducted extensive fieldwork across a suite of projects spanning adaptive management, dust and aeolian processes, rangeland management, sediment transport, dryland inventory and monitoring, biological soil crusts, wildfire, and nonnative species.

Cornell Lab of Ornithology & Western Sydney University

Lyrebird Lab — NSF Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU)
June — August 2022

Superb Lyrebird behavioral ecology. Studied vocal behavior and song dialects across the species' population range in eastern Australia. Deployed SWIFT autonomous audio recorders and motion-triggered cameras near display mounds and managed the resulting data.

Cornell University Plant Pathology Herbarium

Museum Curatorial Assistant — Ithaca, New York

November 2018 — November 2019

Fungal biology. Packaged and labelled fungal specimens for museum research.

TEACHING

University of the Pacific, Department of Biological Sciences

Teaching Assistant — General Biology 51 and 61

Spring & Fall 2025 — present

PUBLICATIONS

Book review

Thomas, C. (2023). Review of *The Compact Australian Bird Guide*, by J. Davies, P. Menkhorst, D. Rogers, R. Clarke, P. Marsack, and K. Franklin. CSIRO Publishing, 2022, 264 pp. *Emu — Austral Ornithology*, 123(2), 182–183.

<https://doi.org/10.1080/01584197.2023.2171437>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

What can bird vocal activity tell us about urban green space? A passive acoustic study in California's Central Valley

American Ornithological Society Conference, Amherst, MA — poster

August 2026

Using automated acoustic monitoring to evaluate avian biodiversity in a structurally diverse urban landscape

Animal Behavior Society Conference, Baltimore, MD — poster

July 2025

Central Valley Birding Symposium, Stockton, CA — talk

November 2025

FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

Central Valley Bird Club Research Grant Award

Two months support

May 2026

Hunter-Nahhas Fellowship Award

University of the Pacific, Department of Biological Sciences — three months support

2025

Sempra Energy Scholarship Program

Cornell University

2018 — 2022

SERVICE & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Morro Bay Bird Festival — San Luis Obispo, CA

Trip leader — Shorebirds of the Morro Bay Marina and Birding Hot Spots for Beginners

January 2025

Occidental College, Moore Lab of Zoology — Los Angeles, CA

Bird specimen preparation volunteer — prepared bird skins for long-term museum storage

March — December 2024

La Verne Bird Banding Station

Bird banding research volunteer — captured birds with mist nets; identified, aged, measured, sexed, and banded birds

July — December 2024

Los Angeles Audubon

California Least Tern monitoring volunteer — community science monitoring during nesting season

June — August 2024

Bird walk guide — led birding outings for LA Audubon and community members

September — October 2024

Cornell University Museum of Vertebrates

Bird specimen preparation volunteer — prepared specimens for long-term museum storage

January — November 2022

SKILLS

Software

R, Python, ArcGIS, Survey123, DIMA, Field Maps, Microsoft Office Suite.